DO NOW · AO1 REVISION

Radioactive contamination

Atomic structure
Paper 1 · Combined and Separate
9 questions

Cover the answers. Answer each question out loud or on paper, then check. Tick the ones you know. Learn the 5 starred (★) questions first.

	QUESTION	ANSWER	✓
1 ★	**What is radioactive contamination?**	The unwanted presence of radioactive atoms on or in other materials.	☐
2	**Explain why radioactive contamination is dangerous.**	The contaminating atoms keep emitting radiation for as long as they remain.	☐
3 ★	**What is irradiation?**	Exposing an object to nuclear radiation.	☐
4	**Explain why irradiation is dangerous.**	The radiation can ionise atoms in living cells, damaging or killing them.	☐
5	**State whether irradiated objects become radioactive.**	No: their nuclei do not become unstable.	☐
6 ★	**Give three precautions that protect people against irradiation.**	Use shielding, keep your distance from the source, and limit the exposure time.	☐
7 ★	**Explain why contamination by an alpha source inside the body is especially dangerous.**	Alpha radiation is strongly ionising and is absorbed by nearby cells.	☐
8	**State what the hazard from radioactive contamination depends on.**	The type of radiation emitted.	☐
9 ★	**Explain why studies of the effects of radiation on humans should be published.**	So that other scientists can check the findings (peer review).	☐

© 2026 PanPhy Labs. All rights reserved.